1. What I'm building

I am building a platform to help users discover and trust beauty professionals more easily. The goal is to improve how clients find, compare, and connect and know what to expect with professionals before booking a service.

It's a vertical marketplace focused on trust and decision-making in the beauty services space.

I'm **focus** on

- Discovery
- Trust
- Pre-booking confidence

<u>Be the place people go BEFORE booking.</u>

2. Problem

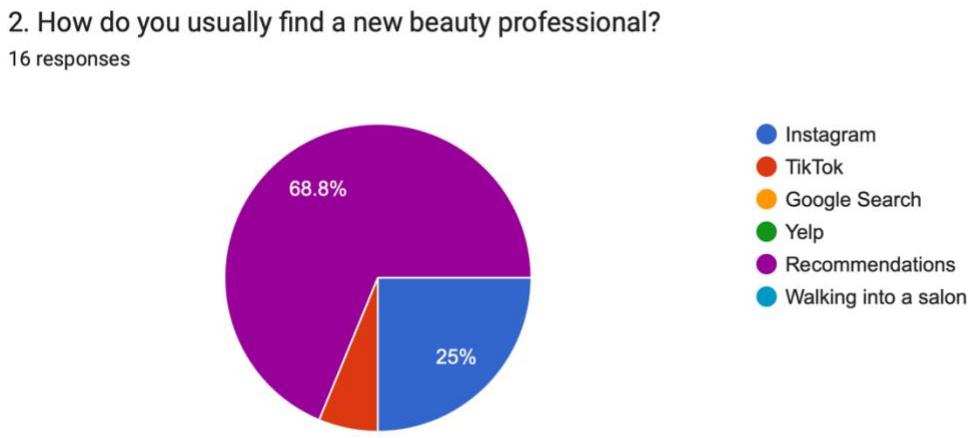
From survey:

Many clients struggle to confidently choose beauty professionals due to:

- Lack of trust and transparency
- Difficulty identifying reliable reviews
- Poor communication before booking
- Uncertainty about quality, pricing, and professionalism

Clients struggle to confidently choose beauty professionals because current platforms like social media lack trust, transparency, and clear signals of quality—leading them to rely heavily on word-of-mouth instead.

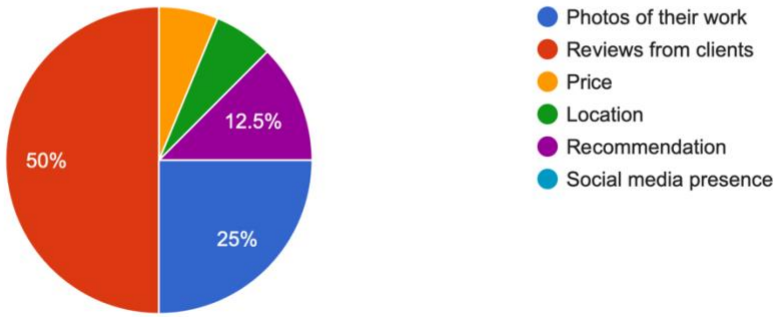
3. Key Insights



68.8% rely on recommendations to find professionals

3. What matters MOST when choosing a beauty professional?

16 responses

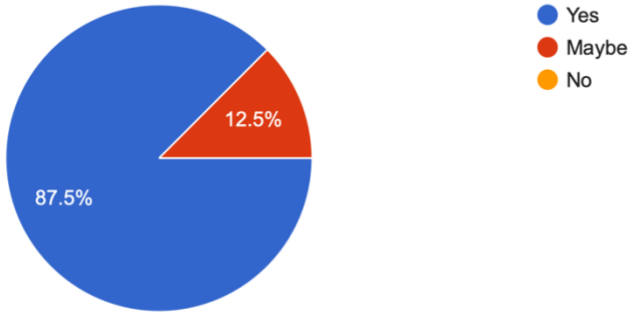


50% say reviews are the most important factor

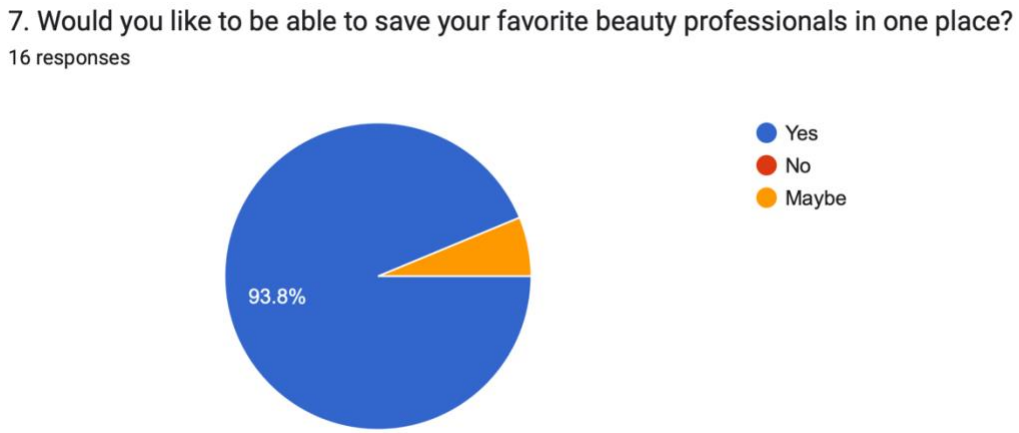
- Many users mentioned trust, communication, and "red flags" as major concerns

6. If there was a platform where you could discover beauty professionals (with portfolios, reviews, pricing, and services in one place), would you use it?

16 responses



86.7% said they would use a platform like this



93.3% want to save favorite professionals

From our survey, 68.8% of users rely on recommendations rather than platforms, while over 50% say reviews are the most important factor. However, many users expressed difficulty identifying trustworthy professionals and recognizing red flags. This shows that the core problem is not discovery, but trust and feel confidence before booking.

4. Proposed Solution

A discovery-first platform that focuses on trust, allowing users to:

- Explore verified beauty professionals
- View authentic reviews and portfolios
- Message professionals before booking
- Save and compare options

5. Key Differentiation

Lumina is a trust-first discovery platform that helps clients confidently choose beauty professionals before booking, using verified results, authentic reviews, and transparent communication signals.

TRADITIONAL MARKETPLACE (WHAT OTHERS DO):

- Find provider
- Book
- Pay

Focus = transaction

My marketplace:

- Discover
- Evaluate
- Trust
- Then book (maybe later)

Focus = decision confidence

6. Initial Features (MVP)

Simple first

1. Landing page
2. Professional profiles (portfolio, pricing, reviews)
3. Discovery feed (recommended / featured)
4. Save favorites

Option 1: VERIFIED RESULTS SYSTEM

Instead of just reviews:

- Clients upload:
  - Before/after photos
  - Tagged to real appointments
- Verified badge = real client

Option 2: RED FLAG / GREEN FLAG SYSTEM

Let users see:

Late responses

No-show complaints

Hidden pricing

On-time

- Transparent pricing
- Consistent results